

ALIEN AGENTS GET ORDER TO REGISTER

State Department Gives Rules for Filing by Propagandists for Foreign Principals

Special to THE NEW YORK TIMES.

WASHINGTON, Sept. 6.—Regulations were issued today for registration with the Secretary of State of persons in the United States engaged in propaganda or other activities for political purposes on behalf of a foreign principal.

The State Department acted under an act passed at the last session of Congress and approved by President Roosevelt June 8. The act became effective today and registrations must be filed within thirty days. Affected are agents of foreign principals whose activities are those of public relations counsel or publicity agent or are in furtherance of any political activity of foreign principals.

This means, it was explained, that a political party in this country being subsidized from abroad would be required to register. Foreign newspaper correspondents in this country engaged solely in that work and merely sending news despatches to their home countries do not have to register.

Data Open to the Public

The law will be administered by the Office of Munitions Control in the State Department for the Secretary of State, and the registrations will at all times be open to public inspection. Failure to register as required is subject to a fine of not more than \$1,000 or imprisonment for not more than two years, or both.

The State Department was sending out letters to many believed to come under the act, but announced that this was voluntary and that failure of a person to receive a letter did not remove any obligation.

The act was passed as a result of the investigation of un-American activities by a special House committee. All persons affected by the act must register and state the names of their employers, the character of their activities and the terms of their contracts. The drafting of the rules and regulations for administering the act called for a considerable definition of terms.

The regulations make clear that for one to be required to register there must be a foreign principal and the registrant must be an agent. A "person" means an individual, a partnership, an association or a corporation.

Requirements Defined

The rules and regulations defined the requirements in detail by saying:

"The act requires the registration of any person who acts or engages to act or agrees to act as: public relations counsel, publicity agent, agent, servant, representative or attorney for: the government of a foreign country, a political party of a foreign country, a person domiciled abroad, a foreign business, a

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foreign partnership, a foreign association, a foreign corporation, a foreign political organization, or any domestic organization subsidized directly or indirectly in whole or in part by any of the above.

"The only persons within these categories excepted from the requirement to register are persons other than a public-relations counsel or publicity agent performing: private activities in furtherance of bona fide trade or commerce, non-political activities in furtherance of bona fide trade or commerce, financial activities in furtherance of bona fide trade or commerce, mercantile activities in furtherance of bona fide trade or commerce, or other activities in furtherance of bona fide trade or commerce, or persons who function in the United

States as diplomatic or consular officers, and whose diplomatic or consular status is of record in the Department of State."

Information to Be Filed

The information to be supplied in the registrations was listed as follows:

"(a) The name, business address and residence address of the registrant;

"(b) The name of the foreign principal or other person or organization for which such person is acting as agent;

"(c) A copy of all contracts of employment under which such person acts or agrees to act as such agent, if written, or a full statement of the terms and conditions thereof, if oral;

"(d) The date when each such contract was made, the date of commencement of activity thereunder and the period during which such contract is to be in effect;

"(e) The compensation to be paid, if any, and the form and time of payment under such contract;

"(f) The name of every foreign principal, or other person or organi-

zation which has contributed or which has promised to contribute to the compensation provided in such contract; and

"(g) If the registrant be a partnership, association or corporation, a true and complete copy of its charter, articles of incorporation, partnership, association, constitution and bylaws, and any other instrument or instruments relating to its organization, powers and purposes."